Manual Testing Interview Question Bank

Deduplicated, ranked by importance and grouped by topic
Prepared for a Software Tester with 4+ years of experience

Questions in your original document	**350**
Exact duplicates removed (same question, different wording of punctuation or case)	**6**
Near-duplicates merged (same question asked in different words)	**110**
Unique questions in this PDF	**234**

Section 1: Critical (Must Prepare)	38 questions
Section 2: High Priority	74 questions
Section 3: Medium Priority	92 questions
Section 4: Low Priority / Quick Revision	30 questions

How to Use This Document

Questions are ordered by how likely they are to be asked and how much weight interviewers give them for a tester with 4+ years of experience. Work top to bottom: finish Section 1 before you spend time on Section 3 or 4. Inside each section the questions are grouped by topic, and within each topic the most important question comes first.

A red tag such as **[asked x3 in your bank]** means the same question showed up several times in your original document (in different wording). Repetition is a good signal that it is a frequently asked question.

Section	What it means
Critical (Must Prepare) 38 questions	Asked in almost every interview at 4+ years. A weak answer here usually decides the outcome, and interviewers follow up with examples from your own project. Prepare a crisp definition plus a real-life example for each.
High Priority 74 questions	Asked frequently, mostly as process, scenario and 'how would you handle' questions. These separate an experienced tester from a fresher, so answer with a structured approach (steps, risks, trade-offs).
Medium Priority 92 questions	Breadth topics. Asked occasionally, usually as follow-ups to your earlier answers or to probe a specific area on your resume. One clear paragraph per question is enough.
Low Priority / Quick Revision 30 questions	Fresher-level definitions and niche topics. Rarely asked at 4+ years, but worth a one-line answer so you are never caught off guard.

What Interviewers Look For (4+ Years)

Topic	What the interviewer is testing
Defect Management	Do you own the defect process end to end? Expect real stories: rejected bugs, leaks, release-day blockers.
Smoke/Sanity/Regression & Automation	Can you build and optimize suites, and decide what to automate and what to leave manual?
Test Design & Documentation	Can you design coverage systematically (EP/BVA, RTM, plan vs strategy) instead of guessing?
Situational & Behavioral	Judgement under pressure: vague requirements, deadlines, conflict, unstable environments.
Agile & Scrum	Where QA fits in sprints: estimation, late stories, scope change, release decisions.
Types & Levels of Testing	Clean definitions and the 'how is X different from Y' comparisons.
Scenario-Based Feature Testing	A structured approach: functional, negative, boundary, security, performance and UX angles.
Integration, DB, API, Perf & Security	Do you think beyond the UI: data consistency, concurrency, injection, slow back ends?

Note: one line in your original file ('Manual Testing - Designed test cases for CSV validation...') was a resume bullet, not a question. It has been converted into an interview question you can expect from it.

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Topic Finder (all sections for one topic)

Use this if you want to study one topic at a time. Each number links to that topic's questions inside a section.

Topic	S1	S2	S3	S4	Total
Defect Management & Bug Life Cycle	7 Qs, p.5	5 Qs, p.7	6 Qs, p.10	5 Qs, p.14	**23**
Smoke / Sanity / Regression & Automation Decisions	7 Qs, p.5	8 Qs, p.7	3 Qs, p.10	2 Qs, p.14	**20**
Test Design, Planning & Documentation	9 Qs, p.5	8 Qs, p.7	4 Qs, p.10	1 Qs, p.14	**22**
Situational & Behavioral Scenarios	5 Qs, p.6	4 Qs, p.7	1 Qs, p.10	-	**10**
Agile & Scrum	5 Qs, p.6	10 Qs, p.8	19 Qs, p.10	-	**34**
Types & Levels of Testing	1 Qs, p.6	11 Qs, p.8	12 Qs, p.11	8 Qs, p.14	**32**
Testing Fundamentals, SDLC & STLC	2 Qs, p.6	1 Qs, p.8	7 Qs, p.11	1 Qs, p.14	**11**
Scenario-Based Feature Testing (E-commerce & Real World)	2 Qs, p.6	14 Qs, p.8	17 Qs, p.11	2 Qs, p.14	**35**
Integration, DB, API, Performance & Security Scenarios	-	5 Qs, p.9	5 Qs, p.12	1 Qs, p.14	**11**
Metrics, Coverage & Reporting	-	5 Qs, p.9	4 Qs, p.12	5 Qs, p.15	**14**
JIRA & Defect Tracking Tools	-	3 Qs, p.9	6 Qs, p.12	-	**9**
QA Mindset, Leadership & Career	-	-	8 Qs, p.12	5 Qs, p.15	**13**

S1 = Critical, S2 = High, S3 = Medium, S4 = Low priority.

Section 1: Critical (Must Prepare) (38 questions)

Asked in almost every interview at 4+ years. A weak answer here usually decides the outcome, and interviewers follow up with examples from your own project. Prepare a crisp definition plus a real-life example for each.

Defect Management & Bug Life Cycle (7)

1. Explain the Defect (Bug) Life Cycle and its states. **[asked x8 in your bank]**
2. What is the difference between Severity and Priority? Give examples (high severity/low priority and low severity/high priority). **[asked x9 in your bank]**
3. How do you write a good bug report? What are the most important things to define in a bug? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
4. What do you do when a developer rejects or disagrees with your defect ("Not a bug", "Rejected")? How do you convince them? **[asked x6 in your bank]**
5. A production issue is reported that you did not catch in testing (or you missed a scenario). How do you handle it? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
6. How do you handle a situation where a high-severity bug is found just before release?
7. What is the most challenging bug you have found and how did you debug it? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

Smoke / Sanity / Regression & Automation Decisions (7)

8. What is the difference between Smoke, Sanity and Regression testing? **[asked x6 in your bank]**
9. What is the difference between Regression Testing and Retesting? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
10. You have 250 manual test cases. On what basis will you segregate them into Smoke, Sanity and Regression suites, and when is each executed? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
11. How do you decide the regression suite scope?
12. How do you decide whether a test case is a good candidate for automation? (e.g. you have 1000 test cases, which do you automate? Long-running scenario: manual or automation?) **[asked x3 in your bank]**
13. Your regression suite takes 1.5 to 5 hours but stakeholders need results in under 1 hour. How do you reduce execution time? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
14. How do you handle flaky automation tests? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

Test Design, Planning & Documentation (9)

15. What is a Test Plan? What does it include and what are the steps to create one? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
16. What is a Test Case and what are its key components? How is it different from a Test Scenario? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
17. How do you prioritize test cases (especially when the release deadline is short)? **[asked x5 in your bank]**
18. What are Entry and Exit Criteria in testing? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
19. What is the difference between Test Plan and Test Strategy?
20. What is a Traceability Matrix (RTM) and why is it important?
21. What are Test Design Techniques? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
22. What is Equivalence Partitioning (EP)? Give an example.
23. What is Boundary Value Analysis (BVA)? Give an example.

Situational & Behavioral Scenarios (5)

24. Tell me about your recent testing project.
25. What challenges have you faced during testing? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
26. How do you test when requirements are unclear, missing or there is no documentation? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
27. How do you manage testing under tight deadlines or release pressure? **[asked x6 in your bank]**
28. How do you handle requirement changes during testing? **[asked x3 in your bank]**

Agile & Scrum (5)

29. What is Agile methodology? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
30. What are the ceremonies followed in Agile/Scrum? Describe each. **[asked x2 in your bank]**
31. In a tight sprint, if a new requirement is added, how will you handle it?
32. If the PO insists on releasing with a known bug, what will you do?
33. In Agile, what will you do if developers deliver a user story very late in the sprint?

Types & Levels of Testing (1)

34. What is Exploratory Testing and when do you use it? **[asked x3 in your bank]**

Testing Fundamentals, SDLC & STLC (2)

35. What is the difference between Verification and Validation? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
36. How do you decide when to stop testing? How do you know your testing is good enough? **[asked x3 in your bank]**

Scenario-Based Feature Testing (E-commerce & Real World) (2)

37. How would you test an E-commerce website (like Amazon or Flipkart)?
38. How would you test a login page beyond normal credentials?

Section 2: High Priority (74 questions)

Asked frequently, mostly as process, scenario and 'how would you handle' questions. These separate an experienced tester from a fresher, so answer with a structured approach (steps, risks, trade-offs).

Defect Management & Bug Life Cycle (5)

39. How do you handle priority vs severity conflicts, e.g. business says a bug is minor but you think it is critical? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
40. How do you handle a bug that is hard to reproduce or occurs intermittently? Give an example. **[asked x2 in your bank]**
41. How do you respond to "It's working on my machine" or "Not reproducible" from a developer or stakeholder? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
42. What is Bug Triage and how is it conducted? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
43. What is Defect Leakage (Escape Defect)? How do you reduce it? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

Smoke / Sanity / Regression & Automation Decisions (8)

44. What is Regression Testing and why is it important?
45. What is the difference between Functional and Regression testing?
46. How many test cases are in your regression suite and how long does it take to execute?
47. Element IDs change frequently, causing locator brittleness. How do you handle it?
48. File upload intermittently fails due to browser/OS dialog or security policy in Chrome/Edge. How do you handle it?
49. Your Pull Request (PR) for automation is not approved for merging. How do you handle it / convince the developer? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
50. When do you automate: in the current sprint or the next sprint?
51. What is the difference between Manual Testing and Automation Testing?

Test Design, Planning & Documentation (8)

52. What is the difference between Boundary Value Analysis and Equivalence Partitioning?
53. What is Risk-Based Testing?
54. How do you ensure your test cases are effective?
55. How do you identify redundant test cases?
56. Explain Decision Table Testing with an example.
57. What is State Transition Testing? Give an example.
58. What are the key components of a test strategy document?
59. What is a Test Summary Report?

Situational & Behavioral Scenarios (4)

60. How do you test when the test environment is unstable? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
61. Have you ever disagreed with a developer? How do you handle conflict with a developer? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
62. How do you convince management to give more time for testing?

63. How do you test with limited test data?

Agile & Scrum (10)

64. What is the difference between Agile and Waterfall?
65. What are the Scrum roles (PO, Scrum Master, Dev Team)? Who is your Scrum Master? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
66. What is Agile Testing?
67. What is a User Story? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
68. What is Acceptance Criteria? How do you test a story when the AC is unclear? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
69. What is the Definition of Done (DoD)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
70. What is a Product Backlog? How is it different from a Sprint Backlog? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
71. What is velocity in a sprint and how is it tracked? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
72. How do you estimate testing effort in Agile?
73. How do you handle a blocker bug in the middle of a sprint?

Types & Levels of Testing (11)

74. What is the difference between Exploratory and Ad-hoc Testing? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
75. What is Ad-hoc Testing? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
76. What are the different levels of testing?
77. What is Integration Testing? What are its types?
78. What is White-Box Testing and how is it different from Black-Box Testing? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
79. What is End-to-End (E2E) Testing? How is it different from System Testing?
80. What is User Acceptance Testing (UAT)?
81. What is Non-Functional Testing? How is it different from Functional Testing?
82. What is Performance Testing?
83. What is Load Testing?
84. What is Stress Testing?

Testing Fundamentals, SDLC & STLC (1)

85. What is the Software Testing Life Cycle (STLC)? Explain its phases. **[asked x3 in your bank]**

Scenario-Based Feature Testing (E-commerce & Real World) (14)

86. How many test cases will you write to test an E-commerce site?
87. How do you test “Add to Cart” functionality in an e-commerce app?
88. How do you test the checkout process with multiple payment methods?
89. How do you ensure test cases cover edge scenarios for a payment gateway?
90. How do you test search functionality with filters (price, brand, category)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
91. How do you test product price calculation (discounts, tax, shipping)?
92. How do you test “Apply Promo Code” / coupons and discount codes? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
93. How do you test the refund flow and refund timeline in e-commerce? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

94. How do you test user registration with email and mobile number?
95. How do you test "Forgot Password" functionality?
96. How do you test an OTP-based login system?
97. How do you test cross-browser compatibility? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
98. How do you test mobile responsiveness of an e-commerce site?
99. How do you test concurrency when multiple users access the same product stock or update the cart at the same time? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

Integration, DB, API, Performance & Security Scenarios (5)

100. What if an API request passes but the UI fails (e.g. Order API says "Success" but UI shows "Failed")?
101. How do you ensure data consistency across UI, API and DB (e.g. DB data integrity after placing an order)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
102. How do you test security in login (brute force, SQL injection)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
103. How do you test performance for a web app?
104. How do you test without a UI (back-end or API-only features)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

Metrics, Coverage & Reporting (5)

105. What are Test Metrics? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
106. How do you report testing progress (to management / in Agile)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
107. How do you ensure maximum test coverage in less time? What is Test Coverage? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
108. How do you ensure 100% test coverage?
109. What KPIs do you show to stakeholders?

JIRA & Defect Tracking Tools (3)

110. What is JIRA and why do QA engineers use it?
111. How do you create a Bug in JIRA?
112. How do QA engineers use JIRA for Agile testing?

Section 3: Medium Priority (92 questions)

Breadth topics. Asked occasionally, usually as follow-ups to your earlier answers or to probe a specific area on your resume. One clear paragraph per question is enough.

Defect Management & Bug Life Cycle (6)

113. What is a Deferred bug?
114. What are Duplicate and Invalid bugs? How do you handle them?
115. What is Root Cause Analysis (RCA)?
116. What is a Showstopper Defect?
117. What is Defect Density?
118. What is Defect Clustering?

Smoke / Sanity / Regression & Automation Decisions (3)

119. How do you test automation scripts in parallel execution?
120. What is Build Acceptance Testing (BAT)?
121. Given test cases with priority -1, 0, 1, 2, what is the sequence of execution?

Test Design, Planning & Documentation (4)

122. What is Use Case Testing?
123. What is Error Guessing?
124. What is Pairwise Testing?
125. How did you design test cases for CSV file validation (format, delimiter, data integrity)?

Situational & Behavioral Scenarios (1)

126. If two developers raise bugs on each other's code, how do you handle it as QA?

Agile & Scrum (19)

127. What is the Sprint Retrospective? What is your role in it as QA? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
128. What is the purpose of Sprint Planning?
129. What is the Daily Stand-up?
130. What is the Sprint Review?
131. How does Story Points estimation work?
132. What are Burndown charts?
133. What is the Agile Testing Pyramid?
134. What is Sprint Testing?
135. What is Continuous Integration in Agile?
136. What is Shift-Left Testing?
137. You have 30+ sprints in your release. How will you design and run your test scripts?
138. If you find a bug during the sprint demo, how do you handle it?

139. How do you test a user story that has dependencies on another team?
140. How do you test bug fixes quickly in Agile?
141. How do you manage test cases in Agile where requirements evolve?
142. How do you test Agile user stories that don't fit in one sprint?
143. How do you test when development and QA environments differ?
144. How do you test when multiple teams deliver microservices in parallel?
145. How do you handle resource allocation in Agile QA?

Types & Levels of Testing (12)

146. What are the types of testing?
147. What is Functional Testing?
148. What is System Testing?
149. What is Usability Testing and why is it important? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
150. What is Security Testing?
151. What is Compatibility Testing?
152. What is Localization Testing?
153. What is Accessibility Testing and why is it important? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
154. What is Monkey Testing?
155. What is Alpha Testing?
156. What is Beta Testing?
157. What is the difference between Static Testing and Dynamic Testing?

Testing Fundamentals, SDLC & STLC (7)

158. What is the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)?
159. What happens in the Requirement Analysis phase of STLC?
160. What is covered in Test Planning and Strategy?
161. What happens in the Test Case Development phase?
162. How do you prepare Test Data?
163. What happens in the Test Execution phase?
164. What are the Test Closure activities?

Scenario-Based Feature Testing (E-commerce & Real World) (17)

165. How do you test multi-currency payment in an e-commerce site?
166. How do you test order cancellation flow? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
167. How do you test order tracking system?
168. How do you test email notifications after order confirmation? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
169. How do you test price updates when a product goes on sale?
170. How do you test stock management in an inventory system?
171. How do you test multi-user login sessions (same account on different devices)?

172. How do you test login with social media (Google, Facebook)?
173. How do you test session timeout?
174. How do you test a shopping cart when multiple tabs are open?
175. How do you test search suggestions (auto-complete)?
176. How do you test "Add to Wishlist" functionality? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
177. How do you test file upload functionality (e.g. profile picture upload)?
178. How do you test localization and internationalization of an e-commerce site (multi-language)? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
179. How do you test caching in e-commerce websites?
180. How do you test a new feature rollout using A/B testing?
181. What would you test in an elevator?

Integration, DB, API, Performance & Security Scenarios (5)

182. How do you test database rollback if a transaction fails?
183. How do you test data migration when moving from an old DB to a new DB?
184. How do you test performance of the product search API?
185. How do you test performance of bulk order processing?
186. What if the API response is slow but the UI has no timeout handling?

Metrics, Coverage & Reporting (4)

187. What is Test Case Effectiveness and how do you measure it? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
188. What is Defect Removal Efficiency (DRE)?
189. What is Requirement Coverage?
190. What is Code Coverage?

JIRA & Defect Tracking Tools (6)

191. What is a Workflow in JIRA?
192. What is an Issue in JIRA?
193. Can JIRA be used for Test Case Management?
194. How do you link issues in JIRA?
195. What are JIRA Filters and how can QA use them?
196. How do you generate reports in JIRA?

QA Mindset, Leadership & Career (8)

197. What does quality mean to you as a QA engineer?
198. How do you ensure quality beyond automation?
199. How do you balance manual and automation tasks?
200. How do you build trust with developers?
201. How do you contribute to a bug prevention mindset?
202. How do you mentor junior testers?

203. What was your proudest QA contribution?
204. Where do you see your career in QA heading?

Section 4: Low Priority / Quick Revision (30 questions)

Fresher-level definitions and niche topics. Rarely asked at 4+ years, but worth a one-line answer so you are never caught off guard.

Defect Management & Bug Life Cycle (5)

205. What is a Bug/Defect in Software Testing?
206. What is the purpose of logging defects early?
207. What is a Latent Defect?
208. What is a Masked Defect?
209. What is a Bug Life Cycle Tool? Give examples.

Smoke / Sanity / Regression & Automation Decisions (2)

210. What is Smoke Testing? Why is it called so?
211. How would you cover character keyboard operation from the context menu using a user-defined keyword? (legacy keyword-driven tool question)

Test Design, Planning & Documentation (1)

212. What is the purpose of Test Documentation?

Types & Levels of Testing (8)

213. What is Scalability Testing?
214. What is Stability Testing?
215. What is Installation Testing?
216. What is Recovery Testing?
217. What is Compliance Testing?
218. What is Internationalization Testing?
219. What is Configuration Testing?
220. What is Pair Testing?

Testing Fundamentals, SDLC & STLC (1)

221. What is Software Testing?

Scenario-Based Feature Testing (E-commerce & Real World) (2)

222. How will you test cart abandonment recovery in an e-commerce site?
223. How do you validate image rendering via UI tests?

Integration, DB, API, Performance & Security Scenarios (1)

224. How do you test log generation in applications?

Metrics, Coverage & Reporting (5)

225. What is Test Execution Status?
226. What is Test Productivity?
227. What is Mean Time to Detect (MTTD)?
228. What is Mean Time to Repair (MTTR)?
229. How do you maintain consistency in test reports?

QA Mindset, Leadership & Career (5)

230. What is your approach to giving feedback in peer reviews?
231. How do you help developers write testable code?
232. What is your role in the sprint retrospective as a QA?
233. How do you upskill your QA team?
234. What books, blogs, or courses have shaped your QA thinking?